Tapasya

Chandy Oommen

In August 1947, two nations, India and Pakistan, were born at the same time. By any stretch of the imagination, of the two, Pakistan would have been considered the easier nation to be governed, considering its smaller size and homogenous nature. As many scholars then opined, India was a land of contradictions and diversities of the extreme kinds. Some Indians found themselves to be more ethnically and culturally similar to people from other countries. Some geographical terrains in our country look more similar to the geographical terrains of other countries than to other parts of India itself. It was therefore understandable that, at the time, some felt India would be impossible to govern, especially through a parliamentary democracy.

Despite this, even in the middle of all these diversities and contradictions, India united as a nation. What made this possible was that India was built on the foundations of brotherhood, secularism and, above all, respect for fellow citizens, irrespective of their background. This may be scoffed at or taken lightly today, but this idea has held our nation together like glue since 1947.

It is because we emphasize fraternity that all our governments listen to us, the people. After all, a democracy is a government of the people, by the people and for the people. In other words, in a democracy, one cannot proceed without taking people into confidence. Only that can deliver good governance and only through that can a nation prosper. It is with a steadfast belief in this that India’s founders and the architects of modern India have led India to great heights since Independence.